Yousef Khudher

// CYBERSECURITY EXPERT · PURPLE TEAM SPECIALIST · CO-FOUNDER

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Iraq · Open to Remote / Relocation

570+ Vulnerabilities Disclosed | 36 Industry Certifications | 14 OffSec Certs (All)

#1 Iraq — HTB Cyber Apocalypse 2025 | 341+ Red & Blue Team Reports | 60%→15% SOC False Positives

CORE SKILLS

- Purple Team Operations
- Adversary Emulation
- Penetration Testing
- Vulnerability Research
- Threat Hunting (OSTH)
- Incident Response (OSIR)
- MITRE ATT&CK
- SIEM / ELK Stack
- Web / Mobile AppSec
- Active Directory Attacks
- Wireless Attacks
- Cloud Security (AWS/Azure)
- ISO 27001 Lead Auditor
- ISO 27701 Lead Auditor
- Security Team Leadership

TOOLS

- Burp Suite
- Metasploit
- Nmap / Nessus
- Wireshark
- ELK / Splunk
- Cobalt Strike

PROGRAMMING

- Python
- Bash / PowerShell
- C / C++

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Purple Team specialist and co-founder with deep hands-on expertise spanning both offensive and defensive operations. I bridge Red Team adversary simulation with Blue Team detection engineering — validating security controls end-to-end using the **MITRE ATT&CK** framework, SIEM/ELK, and custom tooling.

Holder of **all 14 OffSec certifications** — a combination held by very few professionals globally — alongside 36 total industry certifications including **ISO/IEC 27001 & 27701 Lead Auditor**. Ranked **1st in Iraq and 19th globally** at HTB Cyber Apocalypse 2025 out of 18,000+ players. Discovered and responsibly disclosed **570+ vulnerabilities** across HackerOne, global bug bounty platforms, and local Iraqi companies.

A decade of hands-on technical work since 2016 — from freelance development and ISP network administration to national-scale security operations. Based in Iraq, open to on-site or remote engagements in security operations, red/purple team leadership, and AppSec roles globally.

EXPERIENCE

- C# / .NET
- Dart / Flutter
- Java / JavaScript

CERTIFICATIONS

OffSec — All 14

OSCE³ · OSCP+ · OSEP · OSWE · OSED · OSWP · OSWA · OSDA · OSTH · OSIR · KLCP · OSCC-SJD · OSCC-SEC

CyberWarfare Labs

CRTA · MCRTA · MCBTA · DO-RTA

Governance

ISO 27001 · ISO 27701

Network

CCNA · CCNP · MTCNA

EDUCATION

B.Eng. Computer Engineering
University of Mosul

Final project: IDS using ML — detected ARP spoofing, TCP/TFTP anomalies on live traffic.

LANGUAGES

Arabic — Native

English — Professional

PRIVATE COMPANY — CONFIDENTIAL

2025 – Present · Full-time

Security Operations Leader (Red Team) – Co-Founder

May 2026 – Present · 6 mos

Co-founded the venture and leads a **team of 4–5 security engineers** — directing red team strategy and full-scope adversary emulation across initial access, privilege escalation, lateral movement, and post-exploitation. Builds offensive tooling and attack infrastructure including C2 frameworks, redirectors, and custom payloads. Discovered and responsibly disclosed **50+ vulnerabilities** across local Iraqi companies including **Codion Solutions**, **Linkchi for Software Solutions**, and other private organizations.

Red Team · Co-Founder · Adversary Emulation · C2 / Attack Infra · Vulnerability Disclosure

AppSec Specialist / Penetration Tester / Testing Team Lead

2025 – Present · Full-time

Leads application security testing engagements — assessing web and mobile applications, coordinating test coverage across the team, and reporting critical findings to stakeholders.

Application Security · Penetration Testing · Team Leadership · Web / Mobile AppSec

MINISTRY OF INTERIOR — IRAQ

Cybersecurity Specialist – Purple Team · SOC Engineer

Dec 2024 – Present · Full-time

Secures a national-scale environment spanning **1,000+ local and public-facing systems**, **100+ servers**, thousands of endpoints, and **millions of end users**. Reduced SOC false positives from **60% to 15%** through systematic detection tuning, sharply cutting analyst alert fatigue. Delivered **341+ red team and blue team assessment reports** to date. Operates as SOC engineer and cross-layer security advisor across network, endpoint, application, and infrastructure defense, validating detection coverage against MITRE ATT&CK using ELK SIEM.

Red Team · Blue Team · SOC Engineering · MITRE ATT&CK · SIEM / ELK · Threat Intel

MINISTRY OF INTERIOR & MINISTRY OF COMMUNICATIONS — IRAQ

Cybersecurity Competition Judge / Supervisor

2024 – 2025 · Part-time

Supervised and judged 3 national-level cybersecurity competitions on behalf of Iraqi government ministries — two for the Ministry of Interior (2024–2025) and one for the Ministry of Communications (2025).

CTF Design · Competition Judging · Mentorship

MOI CYBERSECURITY DIRECTORATE — IRAQ

CTF Supervisor, National Internship Program

2024 – 2025

Supervised a nationwide internship CTF for the Ministry of Interior Cybersecurity Directorate, with approximately **500 participating students** from across Iraq.

MINISTRY OF INTERIOR — IRAQ · SAME EMPLOYER

Red Team Penetration Tester

2025 – Apr 2026 · 8 mos

Conducted red team engagements and offensive penetration tests against enterprise infrastructure and applications, emulating real-world adversary tradecraft. Findings fed directly into purple team detection-tuning work.

`Red Team` `Adversary Emulation` `Infrastructure Pentesting`

AMC — IRAQ

Penetration Tester

May 2024 – Jan 2025 · 9 mos

Conducted internal and external penetration tests. Developed custom security tooling in Python and C++ to automate vulnerability discovery.

`Web App Pentesting` `Network Pentesting` `Python / C++`

AMC — IRAQ

SOC Engineer

Nov 2023 – Apr 2024 · Full-time

Monitored security events, triaged alerts, and performed incident response with SIEM tooling. Developed detection playbooks to standardize analyst response.

`SOC` `Incident Response` `SIEM`

SELF-EMPLOYED — IRAQ & MENA

Independent Security Consultant & Application Developer

2018 – Present

Advise companies across Iraq and the MENA region on security posture, control gaps, and governance (ISO 27001 / 27701, PCI-DSS, NIST), delivering assessments and penetration tests with formal reports. Designed and built multiple production mobile applications in **Flutter** for local companies, plus websites and custom software with security hardening built in.

`Security Consulting` `GRC Advisory` `Flutter / Dart` `Web Development`

ALMADAR ISP / FREELANCE — IRAQ

Network Administrator & Network Engineer

2022 – 2023

Administered live ISP production network infrastructure — routing, switching, DNS/ARP/TCP-IP, and firewall configuration — alongside call-center IT support.

`Networking` `ISP Infrastructure` `Firewalls`

INDEPENDENT — HACKERONE & REGIONAL PLATFORMS

Bug Bounty Security Researcher

2022 – Present

Discovered and responsibly disclosed 570+ vulnerabilities (Critical → Medium) across global and Iraqi organizations. Delivered detailed PoC reports and remediation guidance. Targeted web applications, APIs, and network infrastructure.

`HackerOne` `Web App` `API Security` `Bug Bounty`

NORTH TECHNICAL UNIVERSITY & UNIVERSITY OF MOSUL — IRAQ

Academic Security Project Supervisor & Mentor

2016 – Present · Part-time

Designed and supervised **100+ Bachelor's, Master's, and PhD projects** in network security and cybersecurity — IDS/IPS, secure communications, and Arduino/Raspberry Pi hardware security with custom PCB design — all achieving Excellent grades. Mentor juniors across UX/UI, databases, and system optimization.

`Mentorship` `Arduino / RPi` `Research`

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

IT Specialist → Senior Data Entry Clerk · Freelance Developer

2016 – 2023

AMC (2021–2023): processed 5,000+ records daily into CRM/ERP at 99% accuracy; standardized templates improved team productivity 20% and cut data errors 10%; mentored 4 clerks and was promoted. **Self-employed (2016–2021):** ran a website-development-as-a-service business delivering **WordPress** sites and custom retail software; bug bounty testing with custom pentest tooling; Minecraft mods and shader packs in Java.

`WordPress` `Web Development` `Java` `Process Improvement`

VULNERABILITY RESEARCH

570+

VULNERABILITIES DISCLOSED

Reported across **HackerOne**, global bug bounty platforms, and direct engagements with regional companies. Includes **50+ vulnerabilities** found in Iraqi companies (**Codion Solutions**, **Linkchi for Software Solutions**, and other private organizations) — responsibly disclosed to strengthen local digital security. Severity range: Critical to Medium.

CTF & COMPETITION ACHIEVEMENTS

#1 Iraq · #19 Global
HTB Cyber Apocalypse 2025
18,000+ players worldwide · Solo

#52 / 796 teams
Global Cyber Skills Benchmark 2025
77/103 challenges · 36,675 pts (HTB)

#51 / 663
RITSEC CTF
Solo squad · Global

#55 / 3,175
EC-Council Hackerverse CTF
August 2025 · Global

Top 61 / 1,668
DownUnderCTF 6
Rev Eng, Web, AI, OSINT, Crypto

Top Rank
VishwaCTF'26
CyberCell VIT + Bugcrowd · 48h